

and assemble **the scattered ones** (נפין) of Israel,
and will gather **the dispersed ones** (פון) of Judah
from the four corners of the earth.

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Ezekiel 11:17 NIV

Therefore say: "This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will gather you from the nations and bring you back from the countries where you have been **scattered** (פון), and I will give you back the land of Israel again."

Zechariah 13:7 NIV

"Awake, sword, against my shepherd, against the man who is close to me!" declares the LORD Almighty.
"Strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be **scattered** (פון), and I will turn my hand against the little ones."

This "scattered" language is a united thread that extends all the way from Genesis 9:18-19 to the conclusion of the scattering at Babylon.

9:18-19	And the sons of Noah who went out from the ark: Shem, Ham, and Japheth ... and from these (מאלה) all the land (כל הארץ) was scattered (פון)		
	10:5	And from these (מאלה) were separated (פרד) the islands of the nations	
		10:18	And afterward the families of the Canaanites were scattered (פון)
		10:25	And to Eber two sons were born, the name of the first was Peleg, because in his days the land (הארץ) was divided (נפלגה)
	10:32	These are the families of the sons of Noah by their generations with their nations, and from these (מאלה) the nations were separated (פרד) in the land (בארץ) after the flood.	
		11:4	"Come let's build for ourselves a city ... lest we be scattered (פון) upon the surface of all the land (כל הארץ)
		11:8	And Yahweh scattered them (פון) from there upon the surface of all the land (כל הארץ)
11:9	Therefore the name was called Babylon, because there Yahweh confused the language of all the land (כל הארץ) , and from there Yahweh scattered (פון) them upon the surface of all the land (כל הארץ)		

Scattered Table. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).

God's preservation of a remnant (Noah and sons) out of the flood becomes an anticipation of God's preservation of a remnant (Abraham and sons) out of the scattering of Babylon. And all of these patterns are designed to anticipate the future preservation of a remnant out of the exile of Judah to Babylon.

Rebellion	Divine Justice	New Eden
Genesis 3-6a Three cycles of rebellion: 1. Garden folly (Gen. 3) 2. Cain: Next generation sins (Gen. 4) 3. Lemek: Next generation sins (Gen. 4) 4. Cosmic rebellion (Gen. 6)	Gen 6:5-8:19 • Flood of divine justice • A remnant (שֵׁאֵר) seed is preserved through the water: Noah + 3 sons (Shem!)	Genesis 8:20-9:17 • Remnant ascends to new Eden • Sacrifices / worship • New Eden blessing / covenant
Genesis 9:18-11:7 Three cycles of rebellion: 1. Garden folly (Gen. 9:20-21) 2. Ham: Next generation sins (Gen. 9:22-28) 3. Nimrod: Next generation sins: Gen. 10:9 4. Cosmic rebellion (Gen. 11:1-7)	Genesis 11:8-32 • Scattering of divine justice • A remnant seed is preserved through the scattering: Terah + 3 sons (Abraham!)	Genesis 12:1-10 • Remnant ascends to new Eden • Sacrifices / worship • New Eden blessing / covenant
Genesis 12-2 Kings Many cycles of rebellion: 1. More garden folly 2. Next generation repeats constantly 3. Cosmic rebellions abound	Genesis 12-2 Kings • Israel's exile due to divine justice • A remnant seed is preserved through the exile (Isa. 4, 11, 40-66) • New sons for Abraham and Sarah (see Isa. 54; Jer. 31)	Isaiah-Jeremiah-Ezekiel • The 12 remnant ascends to new Eden (Isaiah 40-55) • Sacrifices / worship (Isa. 60-62) • New Eden blessing / covenant (Isa. 65-66)
<i>Cycles of Rebellion Macro Design Pattern. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom Noah to Abraham (2020).</i>		

Noah's Failure, Ham's Fall, and the Division of the Brothers (Gen. 9:20-24)

Noah's Foolish Failure

This cryptic and disturbing story has been placed here so that the reader sees a replay of the twin stories of folly and rebellion in Genesis 3-4.

Genesis 9:18-27: Noah's Folly and Ham's "Fall"	Genesis 2-3: Humanity's "Fall"
9:20 Noah was a "man of the ground" (איש האדמה)	3:23 Humanity "works the ground" (לעבד את האדמה)
9:20-21 Noah drinks from his vineyard which he planted (נטע)	3:5-6 Humanity eats from the tree which Yahweh planted 2:8 (נטע)
9:22 Ham saw (וירא) the nakedness of his father	3:7 Humanity's eyes are opened to see (ויראו) their own nakedness
9:22 Ham told (ויגד) his two brothers about his father's nakedness (ערות אביו)	3:11 "Who told (יגיד) you that you were naked (ערום)?"
9:23 Shem and Japheth cover (כסה) their father's nakedness (ערוה), so they do not see (ראה) it	3:7 "And they knew they were naked, and they sewed leaves of a fig tree and made for themselves coverings (חגרה)" 3:21 God makes animal skin (עור) coverings for humanity's nakedness
9:24 Noah awoke from his wine and he knew (וידע) what his son had done to him (עשה לו)	3:7, 13 The eyes of the two of them were opened and they knew (וידעו) they were naked ... "What is this you have done (עשית)?"
9:25 Canaan is cursed (ארור)	3:14, 17 The serpent and the ground are cursed (ארור)
Noah's Folly and Humanity's Fall. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).	

This strange story depicts Noah's folly as a moral failure rather than a rebellion. Getting drunk does not violate a divine command as such, but it is a foolish act that exposes him to danger. In fact, this text is the first of many in the Hebrew Bible that shows the perils of alcohol abuse and its foolish, self-humiliating consequences.

Proverbs 23:31-35 Instructor's Translation

- ³¹ Do not see that (ראה + כי) the wine (יין) is red (אדם),
when it offers its eye (עין) in the cup,
when it walks (יתהלך) down smoothly.
- ³² At the last it bites like a snake (נחש)
and stings like a viper.
- ³³ Your eyes will see (עין + ראה) strange things
and your heart will utter perverse things.

³⁴ You will be like one lying down in the heart of the seas,
 lying on top of the mast.
³⁵ "They hit me," you will say, "but I'm not hurt!
 They beat me up, but I don't know (יָדַעַ) it!
 When can I wake up, so I can find another drink?"

This poem about wine in [Proverbs 23:31-35](#) is saturated with vocabulary from the Eden narrative as well as the flood narrative. This poet is aware of the wine//deception//snake design pattern that links Genesis 3 and 9:20-21 together in a parallel relationship.

Ham's Crime Against His Family

The above link between Ham looking upon his father's nakedness as a result of Noah's eating the fruit of the garden is an excellent example of "dynamic analogy." For more information, see Jonathan Grossman's article "Dynamic Analogies in Esther."

Adam, Eve, and Cain	Noah and Ham
Genesis 3 Eve sees the fruit and eats with Adam "and they knew that they were naked "	Genesis 9:20-21 Noah eats of the fruit of the vineyard, becomes exposed ... "and he knew what his son did to him"
Genesis 4 The son Cain is angry and separates from his brother to kill him	Genesis 9:22-24 The son Ham sees the nakedness of his father and separates from his brothers in a shameful act
<i>Ham's Crime Echoes Genesis 3 and 4. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).</i>	

Noah repeats, in his own way, the folly of Adam and Eve because eating the garden fruit leads to nakedness and exposure to humiliation.

Ham, however, repeats both the folly of Adam and Eve (since they set the paradigm for human folly) and the rebellion of Cain in the heinous act that divides the brotherhood. This is why Ham's story activates the vocabulary of both Genesis 3 and 4. He is replaying the fundamental human folly, as well as choosing (like Cain) his own destructive path that will ruin his family.

There is also an important connection here with Ezekiel 18 and Jeremiah 31, where the prophets deconstruct the proverb that "the parents eat sour grapes, but the children's teeth suffer" ([Ezek. 18:2](#); [Jer. 31:29](#)).

The prophets and Genesis 1-11 disagree with this proverb. Each generation may live within the environment created by the sin of their ancestors, but it is their own choices that create their ultimate destiny. This argument in Ezekiel and Jeremiah is addressed to an exilic audience, and it's likely that this same theme in Genesis 1-11 is compositionally related.

The same dynamics are at work in the David narrative, where his sin with Bathsheba (Gen. 3) and his murder of Uriah (Gen. 4) is repeated by his three children: Amnon rapes Tamar (Gen. 3) and Absalom murders Amnon (Gen. 4).

“Ham, the father of Canaan” (Gen. 9:18, 22)

Why does the narrator tell us twice in this cryptic story that Ham is the father of Canaan? It’s part of a compositional strategy to compare Ham’s line to Cain’s line because Cain gave birth to a line ending with Lemek and his three sons.

Cain's Four Sons (Gen. 4:18-22)	Ham's Four Sons (Gen. 9:18-22; 10:6)
+1 Lemek 1. Yabal 2. Yubal 3. Tubal-Cain	1. Cush 2. Egypt/Mizraim 3. Put +1 Canaan
“Yabal, the father of (אבי) tent-dwellers and livestock” (Gen. 4:20)	“Ham, the father of (אבי) Canaan” (Gen. 9:18)
“Yubal, the father of (אבי) all handlers of lyre and flute” (Gen. 4:21)	“Ham, the father of (אבי) Canaan” (Gen. 9:22)
Cain's and Ham's Sons. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).	

In Cain’s line, the three sons of Lemek are grouped together by similar names so that Lemek stands out, and he is the one who replays the sin of Cain. Ham’s line is inverted so that Canaan is the fourth one who sticks out.

In this way, the narrator hints that just as Cain’s own murderous act was magnified by his descendant Lemek, so also will Ham’s shameful act be magnified by his descendant Canaan. And, of course, Leviticus 18 and 20 make this crystal clear.

The Sin of Ham Against His Father (Gen. 9:22-24)

Two key questions have arisen in the history of interpretation of this cryptic story. For more information, see “Noah’s Nakedness and the Curse on Canaan” from *Journal of Biblical Literature* (Hahn and Bergsma, 2005).

- 1. What did Ham do to his father in the tent?
- 2. Why does Ham’s action result in a curse on his son Canaan?

Numerous interpretations of Ham’s crime against his father throughout history have attempted to answer these two questions.

Voyeurism

Session 28: From Shem to Abraham

Key Takeaways

- Out of the scattering judgment on Babylon, God brings the promise of a blessing for the whole Earth.
- Genesis 12 starts the cycle again, with Abraham and Sarah standing in as our new Adam and Eve.

From Shem to Abram: Translation and Literary Design of Genesis 11:10-26

Prologue

¹⁰ These are the generations of Shem.

First Generation

Shem was one hundred years old, and he caused the birth of Arpachshad two years after the flood;
¹¹ and Shem lived five hundred years after he caused the birth of Arpachshad,
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

Second Generation

¹² And Arpachshad lived thirty-five years, and he caused the birth of Shelah;
¹³ and Arpachshad lived four hundred and three years after he caused the birth of Shelah,
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

Third Generation

¹⁴ And Shelah lived thirty years, and he caused the birth of of Eber;
¹⁵ and Shelah lived four hundred and three years after he caused the birth of Eber,
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

Fourth Generation

¹⁶ And Eber lived thirty-four years, and he caused the birth of Peleg;
¹⁷ and Eber lived four hundred and thirty years after he caused the birth of Peleg,

and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

Fifth Generation

¹⁸ And Peleg lived thirty years, and he caused the birth of Reu;

¹⁹ and Peleg lived two hundred and nine years after he caused the birth of Reu,
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

Sixth Generation

²⁰ And Reu lived thirty-two years, and he caused the birth of Serug;

²¹ and Reu lived two hundred and seven years after he became the father of Serug,
and he had other sons and daughters.

Seventh Generation

²² And Serug lived thirty years, and he caused the birth of of Nahor;

²³ and Serug lived two hundred years after he caused the birth of of Nahor,
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

Eighth Generation

²⁴ And Nahor lived twenty-nine years, and he caused the birth of Terah;

²⁵ and Nahor lived one hundred and nineteen years after he caused the birth of Terah,
and he caused the birth of sons and daughters.

Ninth Generation

²⁶ And Terah lived seventy years,

Tenth Generation

and he caused the birth of of Abram, Nahor and Haran.

Genesis 11:10-26. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).

This genealogy in Genesis 11:10-26 is recursive because it backtracks to Shem to restart his line, from 10:21-31, which had split at Peleg and Joktan in the fifth generation. This genealogy provides a frame around the rebellion of Babylon and the scattering narrative. However, its literary form also imitates the ten-generation genealogy from Adam to Noah because it acts as a frame around all of Genesis 5:1-11:26.

Genesis 5:1-32		Genesis 10:1-32		Genesis 11:10-26	
Vertical Genealogy	Sons of God + the Flood	Horizontal Genealogy	Babylon + the Scattering	Vertical Genealogy	
This is the scroll of the generations ... (5:1)		These are the generations ... (10:1)		These are the generations ... (11:10)	
10 generations From Adam to Noah Ends with 3 sons		From Noah to 70 nations Noah's 3 sons		10 generations From Shem to Abram Ends with 3 sons	
The chosen line		The non-chosen lines		The chosen line	
Babylon Cities. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).					

The literary form of the genealogy matches closely with the genealogy in Genesis 5 but without the death notice (“and he died”) for each generation. Notice that this death formula has been supplied in the OG and Samaritan Pentateuch versions of this genealogy (καὶ ἀπέθανεν / וימת).

Instead of emphasizing death through repetition as in chapter 5, this genealogy emphasizes birth and multiplication, leading to the one generation who is barren—Sarah in [Genesis 11:30](#).

The genealogy of the sons of Noah sits in the middle of this large text block, which links together the 10 generations from Adam to Noah (Gen. 5) and the 10 generations from Shem to Abram (Gen. 11:10-27). This is the main thread of the narrative focus, which traces the seed of the woman from Genesis 3:15.

The genealogy in the middle of this sequence (Gen. 10) is the Table of Nations from the sons of Noah. This text traces the non-chosen lineage of Noah’s three sons—Japheth, Ham, and Shem—and their lines up to the division between Joktan and Peleg. On either side of the non-chosen lines are the rebellious disasters of the flood generation (Gen. 6-9) and Babylon (Gen. 11:1-9). These low moments in the story are framed by God’s preservation and gracious selection of one human line that will bear the promised seed.

Journey From Babylon to Canaan Part 1: Translation and Literary Design of Genesis 11:27-12:5

Introduction

²⁷ Now these are the generations of Terakh.

Part 1: Terakh's Journey

Death and Barrenness in Ur-Kasdim

- a Terakh caused the birth of Avram , Nakhor and Haran ;
a' and Haran caused the birth of Lot .
b 28 And Haran died before his father Terakh
c in the land of his family ,
c in Ur of the Chaldeans .
-
- a 29 And Avram and Nakhor took wives for themselves,
b the name of Avram's wife was Sarai ;
c and the name of Nakhor's wife was Milkah ,
c' the daughter of Haran , the father of Milkah and Iskah.
b' 30 And Sarai was barren, she had no child .

Terakh Takes His Family

- 31 And Terakh took (ויקח תרח...)
Avram his son
and Lot , the son of Haran, the son of his son,
and Sarai his daughter-in-law, his son Avram's wife;

They Go Out of Ur To Enter Canaan but Don't Reach It

- and they went out with them from Ur of the Chaldeans
in order to go to the land of Canaan ;
and they went as far as Haran, and they settled there.

Terakh Age + Death in Haran

- 32 And the days of Terakh were five years and two hundred years;
and Terakh died in Haran .

Part 2: Avram's Journey

Blessing and Children in the Promised Land

- 12:1 And Yahweh said to Avram,
a "Get yourself going
b from your land ,
b' and from your family ,
b' and from your father's house ,
a' to the land which I will show you.

- a 2 **And I will make you a great nation**,
- b and I will bless you,
- a' and I will make your name great;
- b' and so you shall be a blessing.
- a 3 And I will **bless**
- b **those who** **bless** you,
- b' and **the one who** treats you as **cursed**
- a' I will **curse**;
- a and in you all the **families of the land**
- b will find blessing."

Avram's Age + Exit From Haran

4 And Avram went just as Yahweh spoke to him, and Lot went with him, and **Avram was five and seventy years** **when he went out from Haran**.

Avram Takes His Family

5 **And Avram took** (**ויקח אברם**) **Sarai his wife and Lot** the son of his brother and all their possessions which they possessed and the people whom they had acquired in Haran,

They Go Out of Haran To Enter Canaan and Do Reach It

and they went out
in order to go to the land of Canaan
and they went the land of Canaan.

Genesis 11:27-12:5. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).

Notice how this two-step journey is also a two-generation journey. Abram completes what Terah begins, but only because of the word of God that comes to Abram.

Terah's journey begins with two tragic notes: Haran's death and the barrenness of his daughter-in-law Sarai. Sarai's infertility also highlights the contrast between her and her sister-in-law Milcah. They both have royal names ("princess" and "queen"), but Milcah's identity is described in terms of her family relations, while Sarai's identity is described only in relation to her inability to have children.

Terah's journey begins with these tragic notes and then moves in a three-stage process from (1) "taking," to (2) "going out," to then (3) arriving in Haran where Terah dies. Terah's journey begins with Haran's death and ends with his own death in another Haran.

Abram's journey begins with a recall of the two tragic notes that began Terah's journey. He is to leave his family and father's house (marked by death), and God will make him a great nation (thus reversing Sarai's infertility).

Not only will God reverse the tragedies of his family of origin, but he will also bring about an abundant Genesis 1 blessing that will flow out from him to the other families of the nations.

Once Abram has received this divine word of blessing that reverses his father's fate, he begins his own three-step process of (1) "taking," (2) "going out," and then (3) arriving in Canaan.

Abram's Journey: Translation and Literary Design of Genesis 12:6-9

Avram's Sojourn to Shechem

- a 6 **And Avram passed through** (ויעבר) **in the land**
- b **unto the** place of Shechem
- b' **unto the** oak of Moreh,
- a' and the Canaanite was then **in the land**.

Worship + Altar for Yahweh

- a 7 And **Yahweh appeared to Avram** and he said,
- b "To your seed I will give this land."
- a' And **he built there an altar to Yahweh** **who appeared to him**.

Avram's Sojourn to Bethel

- a 8 **And he moved on** (ויעתק) from there
- b to the hill **from the east** of **Bethel**,
- a' and he spread out his tent,
- b' **Bethel** on the west
- b' and Ai **from the east**;

Worship + Altar for Yahweh

- a and **he built there an altar to Yahweh**
- a' and **he called upon the name of Yahweh**.

Avram's Sojourn to the Negev

- a 9 **And Avram journeyed** (ויסע) ,
- a' continually **journeying** (נסוע) to the Negev.

Genesis 12:6-9. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).

Abram completes the journey that his father began when he finally arrives in Canaan. Notice how the scenes alternate precisely between three journey stages. The three stages are punctuated by two stops in Shechem and Bethel, where Abram builds altars and worships Yahweh, who called him and his family out of Ur of the Chaldeans.

A Tale of Two Sojourns

The text of Genesis 11:1-12:9 presents the stories of Babylon and Abram as two parallel journeys. One ends in rebellion and disaster, the other begins with disaster and ends in blessing.

Genesis 11:1-9 A Sojourn Into Disaster	Genesis 11:27-12:9 A Sojourn Into Blessing
Begins with “all the land ... journeying (נסע) from the east (מקדם)” [11:1-2] Concludes with “all the land” being “scattered” (נפוץ / הפיץ) [11:9]	Begins with one family leaving (ויצאו) the place of scattering, Ur of Chasdim [11:31] Concludes with Avram “journeying” (נסע) into Canaan in places “from the east” (מקדם) [12:8-9]
They find a “plain in Shinar” and “they settled there” (וישבו שם) [11:2]	They come to Haran and “they settled there” (וישבו שם) [11:31]
“Let us build (בנה) for ourselves a city and tower” [11:4] “... the city and tower which the sons of ‘adam built (בנה) for themselves” [11:5]	“and Yahweh said” (ויאמר יהוה) [12:1] followed by a reversal of circumstances — from barrenness to birth
“Let us make a name (שם) for ourselves” [11:4]	“I will make great your name (שם) [12:2]
“and Yahweh said” (ויאמר יהוה) [11:6] followed by a reversal of circumstances — from building to scattering	“and [Avram] built (בנה) there an altar to Yahweh” [12:7] “and [Avram] built (בנה) there an altar to Yahweh and he called upon the name (שם) of Yahweh.” [12:8]
A westward sojourn that ends with settlement by humans who use their potential for their own name, so that Yahweh becomes the antagonist and reverses their circumstances	A westward sojourn that ends with settlement by humans who have no potential to make a name for themselves, so that Yahweh becomes the protagonist and reverses their circumstances
Tale of Two Sojourns. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).	

Reflection Question

What are your biggest takeaways from this class?